# Commentary on the Intentional Language

Samādhibhāṣaṭīka · Toh 1206 · Derge Tengyur
དགོངས་པའི་སྐད་ཀྱི་འགྲེལ་པ

The Commentary on the Intentional Language, whose Sanskrit title is transcribed in the Tibetan as Samādhibhāṣaṭīka and whose Tibetan title is Gongpé Ké kyi Drelpa, is Toh 1206 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the commentaries on the tantras. It explains the intentional or coded language of the tantras, the secret vocabulary in which words such as liquor and strength, along with obscure terms like malayaja and kheṭa, stand for hidden meanings, drawing on the code words that the Hevajra Tantra lists and decodes. After paying homage to Vajrasattva and to the vajra ḍākinīs who cut the bonds of conceptual thought, it sets out seven alternative readings of this code, interpreting the same terms in turn through the inner yoga of the winds, through the meanings of individual syllables, through the stages of deity meditation, and through ethical and contemplative counsel, with the seventh being the tantra's own explanation. Its colophon attributes the work to the master Nāgārjuna and records that it was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Mañjughoṣa and the Tibetan monk Dro Sherab Drak at the hermitage of Yerpa.

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In the language of India: samādhibhāṣaṭīka. In the language of Tibet: Commentary on the Intentional Language.

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

As many vajra ḍākinīs as there are,
who cut the bonds of conceptual thought
and fully engage in the work of the world,
to all of them I constantly bow.

I shall set out an explanation by way of seven kinds of enumeration of the code.

Here, liquor is the nectar of space, and it should be drunk without interruption. Strength (bala) is the wind, and by eating it is meant what is called cessation. malayajaṃ: one is to meditate once the elements, the sense faculties and the consciousnesses have settled perfectly together as one; what is meant is "through innate joy." kheṭa is the going of the wind. And this is meditated upon without being held, by one endowed with the four yogas; the meaning is "let it go." The corpse is the yantra of the body, Amitābha, and it is to be

placed there in the meeting. niraṃśu means that one should hold the conviction, "These very bones of mine are my ornaments." brokṣunaṃ is the entering of the wind, and this is done by then bringing it to cessation through the actions of filling and so forth. kṛpiṭa is the unstruck sound, and it is to be struck and made even by bringing the life-force and exertion to cessation. dunduru is conceptual thought, and this is said not to be anything other there. kāliñjara is the intrinsic nature of nonconceptuality; since this is the entering of the wind, what is meant is that it should not be let out. padmabhañjanaṃ is the four cakras: the crown, or the cakra of emanation; or else it is the kakkola of the karmamudrā. The crown's being filled with liquor is present, established by its intrinsic nature; therefore what is called "drinking" is accomplished through its being uninterrupted, and the four cakras are the padmabhañjanaṃ. The four cakras are the lotus vessel. The single one, emanation, is the Eternal One; in another, the Dharma, is Akṣobhya; and further, in enjoyment, is Amitābha; great bliss is the nectar of bodhicitta. By this sequence one should remain in the thought, "I am drinking liquor," and hold the conviction that one is just so. Or else, drinking the liquor that has come from the kakkola of the karmamudrā means that it is to be taken up with the tongue. tripita is that very meditative concentration, which yogins are to eat. mālatīndhanaṃ means that what has been conceived as the four elements is to be eaten. The four-equal (catuḥsama) is Vairocana, and the body remains anointed with it. Musk is Akṣobhya, and sihla is Ratnasambhava. kappūra is Amitābha, and so yogins remain anointed with these essential natures. śāliñja is Amoghasiddhi, and that too is present. kunduruḥni is the coming together of the sense faculties and consciousness, so these too are present. bola is consciousness, or externally it is the vajra. kakkola is the secret lotus, or externally it is the secret place of the wisdom consort (prajñā); and so one should practice yoga with these. That is one enumeration of explanation.

As for the joy that depends on the wisdom consort: flesh is the culmination of supreme joy, which comes from sucking the lower lip of the wisdom consort. Meeting is innate joy, and going is the joy of cessation, since the bodhicitta flows forth. The corpse is the body that has completely given up the bodhicitta of both. The bone ornaments are consciousness that is nonconceptual, free of obscuration and utterly pure. Coming is following in the wake of the Perfection of Wisdom. The hand drum is the sound of vajra and lotus; the unfortunate one is the two seeds, and the fortunate one is the vajra. The untouchable is the

space element of the lotus, and the skull cup is the secret place of the wisdom consort. Food is the śukra (semen) there. Vegetables are the self-arisen flower. Feces are the excrement of the wisdom consort. Urine is so called from urinating right after the wisdom consort. The self-arisen is the jewel of the wisdom consort, and kapūra is the śukra of both. Great flesh is the sucking of the vajra and the kakkola. The union of the two organs is their being joined through yoga. The vajra is the jewel, and the kakkola is the center. That is the second enumeration of explanation.

Liquor is suchness. Strength is arrogance, that is, pride. mālayajaṃ is the very non-apprehension of all beings. kheṭamaḥ is being intent on that path. śukra is having conviction in selflessness. niraṃśu means that one should contemplate oneself as being, by intrinsic nature, like the light of the stainless autumn sky. prokṣunaṃ means that one should practice uninterrupted compassion and hold conviction in it. kripitra is what rouses beings. duṃdhura is realization as suchness. kāliñjara is focusing on nonconceptual suchness. ḍiṇṭimi is the very oneness of the Dharma body and the body of great bliss. padmabhañjanaṃ is space. tripita is meditating on suchness. mālatīndhanaṃ is experience through great bliss. catuḥsamaṃ is the very equality of the four elements. kasturi is to be contemplated as having the intrinsic nature of Akṣobhya. sihla is the arising of the light of gnosis of that meditative concentration. kappūra is what displays the rays of the moon. kunduru is to be contemplated as wisdom and the skillful means that is its very self. bola is emptiness and gnosis, indivisible. kakkola is called the source of phenomena, the Perfection of Wisdom. That is the third enumeration of explanation.

la means existence. ṅa means discipline. ya means wind. If one asks where: in the aperture of Brahmā, which is called the ma of the bindu of the after-sound (anusvāra). aṃsa is sound, the sound of mantra. In the middle of these two is what is called "existence and the disciplining of the wind"; this is the very code of the yoginīs. la is the crown of the head, and a is Īśvara (the Lord), that is, the bindu of bodhicitta right there. la means that it is to be dissolved right there through the sound of mantra. By this, through what is called nan, nirvāṇa will be attained.

ga is the throat, tā is what is to be uttered, and i has the sense of "gone," that is, the sense of nirvāṇa, "passing beyond sorrow." pa means that this is to be accomplished, and va means "by all of you." ā is the great bliss of the realm of Akaniṣṭha, the highest heaven, and sa is the yogin. The one who has done so therefore abides: that is what thi expresses. a is obscuration, and va means

that it has been destroyed: this tells by whom. ṇa is a word of negation, and its sense is how, although there is clinging, it comes to be no clinging. Because that object does not exist, one becomes free of obscuration. a is the object of focus, ga means that it is in space, ta is being scorched by the fire of gnosis, and because of this i is the failing of movement. da is the ḍākinī, and ma is the mudrā ḍākinī: this is the bliss of these two, and it is the very way in which they are joined inseparably. Thus far, the meaning is: having perfected oneself by meditating through these, one should utter the sound of the mantra oṃ hūṃ from the throat, insert it at the crown of the head into the gate of Brahmā, and dissolve it.

ka is the doer. a is the impure, and bha is saṃsāra; pa, on analysis, is consciousness; and ya means that the yogin should apply himself earnestly through this sequence. bha is delusion, and pa is consciousness. ya means that the yogin should apply himself earnestly through this sequence. a is ignorance. bha is delusion. va is what is true only as mere cognition. ya means that the yogin should apply himself earnestly through this sequence. a is the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā (Selflessness). bha is the Blessed One, the aspect of existence. va is mere cognition. ya means that the yogin should apply himself earnestly through this sequence. bha is the elements, and va is the intrinsic nature of cognition. ya means that the yogin should apply himself earnestly through this sequence.

a is the letter a, that is, a la la la la. sa is "all." va is "in the source of phenomena." śa is "relying on that." ra is "because it is the abode of bliss." Therefore the Blessed Lady relies on the Blessed One. ka is "by which," pā is protecting, and la is the abode: it is called the source of phenomena, and in it these beings are especially gathered. bha is the sun. ka is the moon. Thus the Blessed One is the sun, and the Blessed Lady is the moon; marked by their own seed syllables, they must be joined by means of the two letters. ta means that the sound is to be uttered. pa means that, having made them separate and distinct, one should utter both: once the one has dissolved, the second is to be uttered. ya means that, whether by tightening or by relaxing, one should make yaṃ part of the sound of the wind, insert it fully into the gate of Brahmā, and dissolve it. ja is water, and na means that what is in the channels and so forth is to be drunk; the sense is that fatigue is to be soothed.

ga is the qualities of Vajradhara. u means that the yogin has certainly become so. tha is thanu, meaning that one becomes like that, equal to Amitābha. ma is the mudrā. u is skillful means, and tā is protecting, that is, guarding the bliss in

the means even as it produces bliss. sva is mind. ya is wind. bha means "by being distinct." u is having become fully pacified, meaning "having drawn near to nirvāṇa." sva is mind, ya is wind, and bhu is the body: all three have become fully pacified. sa is bliss, and bha is distinction. ya is being endowed with effort; the meaning is that there is no other distinction. Nirvāṇa is not thought of as something distinct. Since bha is existence, it becomes fully pacified through u and these. sa is supreme bliss. u is its dawning as bliss. kri means from the dissolving that comes through habituation to that sequence. ka is what has passed beyond parts, meaning "partless." Immediately after that, sur is the dawning of that light of the sun's gnosis.

ma is wind, ha is destroyed, that is, dissolved, and a is the support of mind and wind. la is the mind. a is the object of the mind, just a bindu. sa is the bindu. ma is the jewel, that is, the vajra, and there it is the very letter ha, transformed. Further, it is joined with the letter ha in that jewel, and what abides there is bodhicitta. a is the lotus. ma is the jewel at its center. Whatever has formed there is their fluid. Through these it is said that the mere bindu is one's own awareness. sa is pervading everything. da is the petals of the four cakras. va is the hub, the seed letters of the four cakras: the sound of the four letters oṃ āḥ hūṃ oṃ is to be dissolved, and e is the source of phenomena, its bindu in the cakra of emanation. da is what is subdued by this practice. Further, ra is the seed of fire. Or else it is the other one as well. ya is yaṃ ṅaṃ, the seeds of the four yogas. oṃ is oṃ, or the seed of Brahmā. ga is the seeds of Gaurī and the others: the fourteen letters gaṃ caṃ vaṃ gham paṃ saṃ laṃ ṭaṃ aṃ ā and the rest are the seeds. If one contemplates in this way through this practice, the yogin will obtain what he desires, through the kindness of the Vajra Liberator. pa is this supreme gnosis. ja means "by beings." ra is the protection by beings through this very one. ga means "by which."

kā means "in which." ga means "how." oṃ means oli, by way of oṃli. Just as with oṃli, the sound oli means "by the proper sequence," and also "in the proper sequence, it is attained in the proper sequence"; that is to say, this is supplied in addition. lā means dissolving: into the lotus, the vajra, and the kunduru. The lotus is emanation, and the dissolving is into that. The vajra is the tip, so the dissolving is into that, and it is visualized as a subtle drop like a white mustard seed. kundurunaṃ is going and coming: the dissolving is into that, and, having settled the mind, one is to perform the going and coming. Furthermore, the three kā letters indicate the triad of body, speech, and mind,

and their being one is the melting of bodhicitta. Moreover, the letter o shows that where it reaches the gate of the vajra, just that is the dissolving. This is the fourth enumeration of the explanation.

Liquor is meditation, and wisdom is the drink. Strength is the strength of that wisdom. malayajaṃ: the pledge being (samayasattva) and the gnosis being (jñānasattva) should be made one. kheṭaḥ is radiating the light rays of one's own seed. brekṣyanaṃ is gathering them back again into one's own seed. śrabasvā is relying on Nairātmyā (the goddess Selflessness). niraṃśu is the bone ornaments, such as the garland of skulls. kripiṭa is the sign of mantra. duṃdhura is ordinary pride. kālañjiraṃ is assuming the pride of the deity. ḍiṇḍimaṃ is the opening at the extremity of the Blessed Lady's source of phenomena (dharmodaya). padmabhañcanaṃ is the sixteen skull cups of the Blessed One and the single skull cup of the Blessed Lady, or else the bhaga itself. tripitagaraṃ is the union in which the two are perfectly joined as a couple, or else the fluid of the Blessed Lady. mālatinadhanaṃ is viewing the lord of the maṇḍala and the deities of the maṇḍala as clearly distinct. The four equal parts are the chamber, wholly produced from mind, in which the four elements are equal. Musk is the state of having melted. sihli is the seed of the Blessed Lady, aṃ. kappūr is the seed of the Blessed One, hūṃ. salijaṃ is the completion of the forms of both once again, as before. gunduru is the fourth, the union of the two secret places of the ḍāka and the ḍākinī. bola is the sealing by the Tathāgatas, Akṣobhya and the rest. By this sequence, the abode that supports beings, the guarding of great bliss, the emanation body emanated by the Blessed One, whose intrinsic nature is emptiness and which is called Sukhāvatī (the Blissful), is expressed by the code word kakkolā. This is the fifth enumeration of the explanation.

Liquor is intoxication by ignorance, and drinking is destroying it. Flesh is being puffed up with ordinary pride, and that too is to be eaten and chewed up. Gathering is coming together with the holy ones. Going is the activity of the happy destinies. The corpse is the activity of realizing the Dharma of Nairātmyā. The bone ornaments are reducing the body, through austere conduct, to nothing but a lattice of bones. Coming is not depending on sense objects. The small drum means that one should regard these beings as being like echoes. The unfortunate are the ten non-virtues. The fortunate is virtue. The untouchable is meditative concentration on emptiness. kapāla is guarding the two bodies, which is called protecting Dharma and bliss. Food is attending upon the guru with reverence. Vegetables are the full ripening of one's own

mind by means of the one and the many. Excrement is Vairocana. Urine is Akṣobhya. The self-arisen is Ratnasambhava. kappāra is Amitābha. Great flesh is Amoghasiddhi. Toward the entity in which these have become one, one should cultivate the conviction, "I myself am of its very nature," and these should be brought into union. Eating the nectar, too, is just this. The union of the two organs should be construed as "The faculties are mind alone." The vajra is cutting off, by means of emptiness, the side that is the essence of all obscurations. The lotus is the thorough viewing of the four cakras. "I am by nature emanation" is the thorough viewing of emanation. "I am by nature Dharma" is the thorough viewing of Dharma. "I am by nature complete enjoyment" is the thorough viewing of complete enjoyment. "I am by nature great bliss": since great bliss is the thorough viewing, this is the thorough viewing of the four cakras. "By this thorough viewing yogins should abide": this is the sixth enumeration of the explanation, and what is explained in the root text is the seventh enumeration of the explanation.

This explanation of the intent in seven enumerations,
Which gives voice through seven limbs,
Like a string of pearls upon the throat,
The best of beings should devote themselves to its meaning.

The teaching of the ḍākas' intent:
Whatever learned one, out of pride
And in delusion, sets out to refute it
Thereby disparages the ḍākas and ḍākinīs.

This completes the chapter of the seven enumerations explained by the vajra ḍākinīs, composed by the master, the noble Nāgārjuna. The Indian preceptor Mañjughoṣa and the Tibetan translator, the monk Dro Sherab Drak, translated it at the hermitage of Yerpa.

## Translator's Notes

• Shes rab (prajñā) is rendered "wisdom consort" where it denotes the female partner in the practice. In the line on feces, bshad pa ("explanation") is read as bshang ba ("feces"), which alone fits the sense; gzhi bas pa, used twice, is read as gzhibs pa ("sucked"). Rtag pa, set beside Akṣobhya and Amitābha in assigning buddhas to the cakras, is rendered "the Eternal One"; it may be the epithet Śāśvata of one of the buddhas, but this is uncertain.
• Two glossary words occur here in other senses: gdon pa is the verb "to utter, recite," not graha, and 'gog pa'i tshig is the grammatical "word of negation," not "cessation." Rdo rje sgrol mdzad, through whose kindness the yogin succeeds, could not be identified with confidence and is translated as "the Vajra Liberator."

• At the opening, the Tibetan gang lag is read as gang la, "in which," followed by the letter ga, the separator between them having dropped out. "The small drum" renders rde'u chung, taken as the hand drum (ḍamaru) of the code list, which suits the comparison with echoes. The fifth enumeration reads the code words of the Hevajra Tantra's intentional language as stages of deity practice, the sixth reinterprets the tantra's own decoding of them (liquor, flesh, meeting, going, corpse and so on), and the seventh is that decoding as the tantra itself gives it. Bde ba can, "the Blissful," is the standard rendering of Sukhāvatī; here it names the lotus as the abode of bliss.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.